

The Devil Wears Prada and the Material Self: A Reflection



Watching Andy in Runway is a perfect study of the material self. At the beginning, she completely rejects the idea that clothes or possessions matter, believing her intellect is the only thing of value. It is the exact same mindset you easily fall into as a computer science student. You might walk around in the same hoodie for three days, thinking that as long as your code compiles, the physical things you wear or own are just superficial distractions. But Andy's transformation with her designer wardrobe shows that the material self is actually an extension of who we are. The things we put on our bodies and the items we surround ourselves with dictate how the world interacts with us.



This hits close to home when you think about the tools of our trade. Getting your hands on a high-performance rig, a proper mechanical keyboard, or even just setting up a clean workspace is our version of Andy putting on the Chanel boots. At first, you might think a busted, overheating laptop is fine as long as you have the logic in your head. But eventually, you realize that investing in your material environment shifts your entire mindset. The hardware you own and the way you present yourself are not just empty flexes. They ground you, build your confidence, and actively shape how you tackle the daily grind of your degree.

